

Social networking

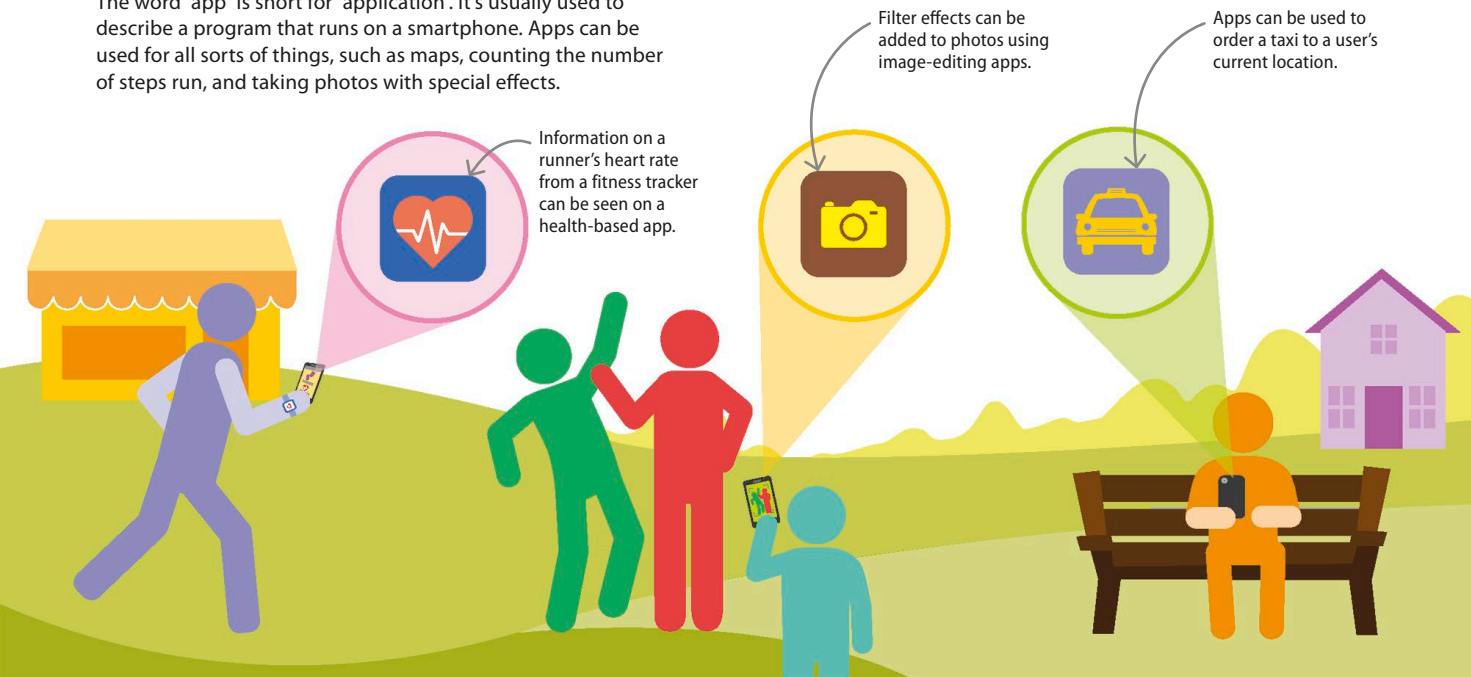
Social networking sites and applications have become increasingly popular in recent years. Facebook is typically used by people to connect with friends and family. It's also possible to restrict access to posts at different levels – for instance, they can be seen by only friends of the user. Twitter is more public and people often “follow” people they don't know. Instagram is similar to Twitter, but based on images.

▽ Apps

The word “app” is short for “application”. It's usually used to describe a program that runs on a smartphone. Apps can be used for all sorts of things, such as maps, counting the number of steps run, and taking photos with special effects.

“Technology and social media have brought power back to the people.”

Mark McKinnon (b. 1955), American political advisor and reform advocate



File compression

Compression programs, also called zip programs, reduce the size of a file in a reversible way. This allows them to be emailed and then uncompressed by the receiver. They can also be used to compress a folder of files, which can be particularly useful when emailing several photos.

▽ Reversing the process

The same programs that compress files can also be used to uncompress them. Many computers come complete with compression software, which is also available online.

